

**ONLY CONNECT** A session of Blindfolded Conversation in Delhi organised by Justbaat

# GOTTA BE TALKIN', WALKIN', LIVIN'...

***A few clubs and groups helping youngsters meet and socialise across activities***

### ↘ DINNER WITH STRANGERS

**Activity:** Curated suppers where strangers share meals and conversations

**Footfall:** 40–60 per event

**Cities:** Delhi NCR, Kolkata, Trivandrum, Bhubaneswar

**Cost:** Rs 1,000–Rs 2,000 per head

### ↘ GIRLS WHO WALK

**Activity:** Women gather for weekly city walks for safe, casual socialising

**Footfall:** 80–150 per walk

**Cities:** Delhi, Mumbai, Bengaluru

**Cost:** Free

### ↘ BLINDFOLDED CONVERSATIONS

**Activity:** Participants talk without visual cues, focusing on voice and words

**Footfall:** 25–40 per session

**Cities:** Delhi, Bengaluru

**Cost:** Rs 500–Rs 1,000

### ↘ MYSTERY WALKS

**Activity:** Secret-location walks with strangers, ending in cafés or bars

**Footfall:** 50–70 per walk

**Cities:** Delhi NCR, Pune, Mumbai

**Cost:** Rs 800–Rs 1,200

### ↘ GAME NIGHTS WITH STRANGERS

**Activity:** Board/ card games

**Footfall:** 40–80 per night

**Cities:** Delhi NCR, Hyderabad, Chennai

**Cost:** Rs 500–Rs 1,000

### ↘ FAKE WEDDINGS

**Activity:** Staged wedding parties where attendees play roles, bond over revelry

**Footfall:** 100–250 per event

**Cities:** Bengaluru, Pune, Delhi NCR

**Cost:** Rs 2,000–Rs 3,500

### ↘ SILENT READING CLUB

**Activity:** Reading together in silence, then optional chats or book swaps

**Footfall:** 30–80 per session

**Cities:** Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Bengaluru, Pune, Hyderabad, Chennai

**Cost:** Free–Rs 300

### ↘ HUMAN LIBRARY

**Activity:** Attendees 'borrow' people with lived experiences for conversations

**Footfall:** 60–150 per event

**Cities:** Bengaluru, Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Kochi, Chandigarh

**Cost:** Rs 200–Rs 600

riving alone is no longer a social risk—it is the point. On a wider bandwidth, the money trail is impressive—the FICCI–EY media and entertainment analysis pegs organised live events at over Rs 12,000 crore in 2024, with growth on the back of ticketed gigs, cultural festivals and curated social experiences.

Deloitte's 2025 Gen Z & Millennial Survey shows Indian Gen Zers value emotional well-being as much as money and success. International research backs this. A 2023 study in *Scientific Reports* found in-person communication the strongest predictor of mental health during lockdowns. Similarly, a 2024 report in *Current Research in Behavioral Sciences* showed young adults rate offline, face-to-face interactions as more enjoyable than digital exchanges. The takeaway is not anti-tech but pro-human: use the phone to discover people, then put it face-down to meet them.

Dr Samir Parikh, director of mental health at Fortis Healthcare, says what sustains friendship is the micro-signals screens can't deliver. "Tone, timing, eye contact—the signals our brains use to judge safety and trust." Dr Sameer Malhotra, senior director, department of mental health and behavioural sciences at Max Healthcare, adds that even short in-person encounters make people more willing to return. That is why weekly reading circles, monthly dinners and fortnightly improv jams matter. They are not dramatic; they are dependable. And dependability, Dr Malhotra notes, is the soil in which friendships grow.